THE BOOK OF

JOEL

A Devastation of the Land by Locusts. Terribleness of the Visitation

1 The [a]word of Jehovah that came to [b]Joel the son of Pethuel.

2 [c]Hear this, ye [d]old men, and give ear, all ye inhabitants of the land. Hath this been in [e]your days, or in the days of your fathers? 3 [f]Tell ye your children of it, and *let* your children *tell* their children, and their children another generation. 4 That which [1]the [g]palmer-worm hath left hath [1]the locust eaten; and that which the locust hath left hath [1]the [h]canker-worm eaten; and that which the canker-worm hath left hath [1]the [i]caterpillar eaten.

5 Awake, ye [k]drunkards, and weep; and wail, all ye drinkers of wine, because of the sweet wine; for it is [l]cut off from your mouth. 6 For a [m]nation is come up upon my land, strong, and without number; his teeth are the teeth of a lion, and he hath the jaw-teeth of a lioness. 7 He hath [n]laid my vine waste, and [2]barked my fig-tree: he hath made it clean bare, and cast it [3]away; the branches thereof are made white.

8 Lament like a virgin [o]girded with sackcloth for the husband of her youth. 9 The [p]meal-offering and the drink-offering are cut off from the house of Jehovah; the [q]priests, Jehovah's ministers, mourn. 10 The field is [r]laid waste, the land mourneth; for the grain is destroyed, the [s]new wine is [4]dried up, the oil languisheth. 11 [5]Be [t]confounded, O ye husbandmen, wail, O ye vinedressers, for the wheat and for the barley; for the [u]harvest of the field is perished. 12 The [v]vine is [4]withered, and the fig-tree languisheth; the [x]pomegranate-tree, the [y]palm-tree also, and the [z]apple-tree, even all the trees of the field are withered: for [a]joy is [4]withered away from the sons of men.

13 [b]Gird yourselves *with sackcloth*, and lament, ye [c]priests; [d]wail, ye ministers of the altar; come, [e]lie all night in sackcloth, ye ministers of my God: for the meal-offering and the drink-offering are withholden from the house of your God. 14 [f]Sanctify a fast, call a solemn assembly, gather the [6][g]old men *and* all the inhabitants of the land unto the house of Jehovah your God, and [h]cry unto Jehovah.

15 [i]Alas for the day! for the [k]day of Jehovah is at hand, and as [l]destruction from [7]the Almighty shall it come. 16 Is not the [m]food cut off before our eyes, *yea*, [n]joy and gladness from the house of our God? 17 The [o]seeds [8]rot under their clods; the garners are laid desolate, the barns are broken down; for the grain is [4]withered. 18 How do the [p]beasts groan! the herds of cattle are perplexed, because they have no pasture; yea, the flocks of sheep [9]are made desolate. 19 O Jehovah, to [q]thee do I cry; for the [r]fire hath devoured the [10]pastures of the wilderness, and the flame hath burned all the trees of the field. 20 Yea, the beasts of the field [s]pant unto thee; for the [t]water brooks are dried up, and the fire hath devoured the [10]pastures of the wilderness.

2 [u]Blow ye the trumpet in Zion, and sound an alarm in my holy mountain; let all the inhabitants of the land tremble: for the [v]day of Jehovah cometh, for it is nigh at hand; 2 a day of [x]darkness and gloominess, a day of clouds and thick darkness, as

[a] Jer. 1. 2; Ezek. 1. 3; Hos. 1. 1
[b] Acts 2. 16
[c] Hos. 4. 1; 5. 1
[d] ver. 14; Job 8. 8
[e] ch. 2. 2; Jer. 30. 7
[f] Ex. 10. 2; Ps. 78. 4
[g] ch. 2. 25; Am. 4. 9
[h] Nah. 3. 15, 16
[i] Is. 33. 4
[k] ch. 3. 3
[l] ver. 7, 12
[m] ch. 2. 2, 11, 25
[n] Am. 4. 9
[o] ver. 13; Am. 8. 10
[p] ver. 13; ch. 2. 14; Hos. 9. 4
[q] ch. 2. 17
[r] Is. 24. 4, 7
[s] Hos. 9. 2
[t] Jer. 14. 4; Am. 5. 16
[u] Is. 17. 11; Jer. 9. 12
[v] Hab. 3. 17, 18
[x] Hag. 2. 19
[y] S. S. 7. 8
[z] S. S. 2. 3
[a] Is. 16. 10; 24. 11
[b] ver. 8; Jer. 4. 8; Ezek. 7. 18
[c] ver. 9; ch. 2. 17
[d] Jer. 9. 10
[e] 1 K. 21. 27
[f] ch. 2. 15, 16
[g] ver. 2
[h] Jon. 3. 8
[i] Jer. 30. 7; Am. 5. 16
[k] ch. 2. 1, 11, 31
[l] Is. 13. 6; Ezek. 7. 2-12
[m] Is. 3. 7; Am. 4. 6, 7
[n] Dt. 12. 6, 7; Ps. 43. 4
[o] Is. 17. 10, 11
[p] 1 K. 18. 5; Jer. 12. 4; 14. 5, 6; Hos. 4. 3
[q] Ps. 50. 15; Mic. 7. 7
[r] Jer. 9. 10; Am. 7. 4
[s] ver. 18; Ps. 104. 21; 147. 9
[t] 1 K. 17. 7; 18. 5
[u] ver. 15; Zeph. 1. 16
[v] ver. 11, 31; ch. 1. 15; 3. 14
[x] ver. 10, 31; Zeph. 1. 15

[1] Probably, different kinds of locusts, or locusts in different stages of growth.
[2] Or, *broken* [3] Or, *down* [4] Or, *ashamed*
[5] Or, *The husbandmen are confounded, the vinedressers wail*
[6] Or, *elders* [7] Heb. *Shaddai.* [8] Or, *shrivel*
[9] Or, *suffer punishment* [10] Or, *folds*

Terribleness of the Visitation. A Call to Fasting and Prayer. Jehovah shows Pity and Favor

the dawn spread upon the mountains; a [a]great people and a strong; there hath [b]not been ever the like, neither shall be any more after them, even to the years of many generations. 3 A [c]fire devoureth before them; and behind them a flame burneth: the land is [d]as the garden of Eden before them, and behind them a [e]desolate wilderness; yea, and none hath escaped them.

4 The [f]appearance of them is as the appearance of horses; and as [1]horsemen, so do they run. 5 Like the [g]noise of chariots on the tops of the mountains do they leap, like the noise of a [h]flame of fire that devoureth the stubble, as a strong people set in battle array. 6 At their presence the peoples are in [i]anguish; all [k]faces are waxed pale. 7 They run like [l]mighty men; they [m]climb the wall like men of war; and they [n]march every one on his ways, and they break not their ranks. 8 Neither doth one thrust another; they march every one in his path; and [2]they burst through the weapons, and [3]break not off *their course.* 9 They [o]leap upon the city; they run upon the wall; they climb up into the [p]houses; they [q]enter in at the windows like a thief. 10 The earth [r]quaketh before them; the heavens tremble; the [s]sun and the moon are darkened, and the stars withdraw their shining. 11 And Jehovah [t]uttereth his voice before [u]his army; for his camp is very great; for he is [v]strong that executeth his word; for the [x]day of Jehovah is great and very terrible; and [y]who can abide it?

12 Yet even now, saith Jehovah, [z]turn ye unto me with all your heart, and with [a]fasting, and with weeping, and with mourning: 13 and rend your [b]heart, and [c]not your garments, and turn unto Jehovah your God; for he is [d]gracious and merciful, slow to anger, and abundant in lovingkindness, and [e]repenteth him of the evil. 14 Who knoweth [f]whether he will not turn and repent, and leave a [g]blessing behind him, even a [h]meal-offering and a drink-offering unto Jehovah your God?

15 [i]Blow the trumpet in Zion, [k]sanctify a fast, call a solemn assembly; 16 gather the people, [l]sanctify the assembly, assemble the [4]old men, gather the children, and those that suck the breasts; let the [m]bridegroom go forth from his chamber, and the bride out of her closet. 17 Let the [n]priests, the ministers of Jehovah, weep [o]between the porch and the altar, and let them say, [p]Spare thy people, O Jehovah, and give not thy heritage to [q]reproach, that the nations should [5]rule over them: wherefore should they say among the peoples, [r]Where is their God?

18 Then was Jehovah [s]jealous for his land, and had [t]pity on his people. 19 And Jehovah answered and said unto his people, Behold, I will send you [u]grain, and new wine, and oil, and ye shall be satisfied therewith; and I will [v]no more make you a reproach among the nations; 20 but I will remove far off from you the [x]northern *army,* and will drive it into a land barren and desolate, [6]its forepart [7]into the [y]eastern sea, and its hinder part [7]into the [z]western sea; and its [a]stench shall come up, and its ill savor shall come up, because it hath done great things.

21 [b]Fear not, O land, be glad and rejoice; for Jehovah hath [c]done great things. 22 Be not afraid, ye beasts of the field; for the [d]pastures of the wilderness do spring, for the tree beareth its fruit, the fig-tree and the vine do yield their strength. 23 Be glad then, ye [e]children of Zion, and [f]rejoice in Jehovah your God; for he [g]giveth you the former rain [8]in just measure, and he causeth to come down for you the rain, the former rain and the [h]latter rain, [9]in the first *month.* 24 And the [i]floors shall be full of wheat, and the vats shall overflow with new wine and oil. 25 And I will restore to you the years that the [k]locust hath eaten, the canker-worm, and the caterpillar, and the palmer-worm, my great army

[a] ver. 11, 25; ch. 1. 6
[b] ch. 1. 2; Lam. 1. 12; Dan. 12; 12. 1
[c] Ps. 97. 3; Is. 9. 18, 19
[d] Is. 51. 3; Ezek. 36. 35
[e] Ex. 10. 5, 15; Ps. 105. 34, 35
[f] Rev. 9. 7
[g] Rev. 9. 9
[h] Is. 5. 24; 30. 30
[i] Is. 13. 8; Nah. 2. 10
[k] Jer. 30. 6
[l] Is. 5. 26, 27
[m] ver. 9
[n] Prov. 30. 27
[o] ver. 7
[p] Ex. 10. 6
[q] Jer. 9. 21
[r] ch. 3. 16; Ps. 18. 7; Nah. 1. 5
[s] ver. 31; ch. 3. 15; Is. 13. 10; 34. 4; Jer. 4. 23; Ezek. 32. 7
[t] ch. 3. 16; Ps. 46. 6; Is. 13. 4
[u] ver. 2, 25
[v] Jer. 50. 34; Rev. 18. 8
[x] ver. 1, 31; ch. 1. 15; 3. 14
[y] Ezek. 22. 14
[z] Dt. 4. 29; Ezek. 33. 11
[a] Dan. 9. 3
[b] Ps. 51. 17; Is. 57. 15
[c] Jer. 41. 5
[d] Ex. 34. 6
[e] Jer. 18. 8; 42. 10; Am. 7. 3, 6
[f] Jer. 26. 3; Am. 5. 15; Jon. 1. 6; 3. 9; Zeph. 2. 3
[g] Hag. 2. 19
[h] ch. 1. 9, 13

[i] ver. 1
[k] ch. 1. 14; 2 K. 10. 20; Jer. 36. 9
[l] 1 S. 16. 5; 2 Chr. 29. 5
[m] Ps. 19. 5
[n] ch. 1. 9
[o] 2 Chr. 8. 12; Ezek. 8. 16
[p] Is. 37. 20; Am. 7. 2, 5
[q] Ps. 44. 13; 74. 10
[r] Ps. 79. 10; 115. 2
[s] Zech. 1. 14; 8. 2
[t] Is. 60. 10; 63. 9, 15
[u] Jer. 31. 12; Hos. 2. 21, 22
[v] Ezek. 34. 29; 36. 15
[x] Jer. 1. 14, 15
[y] Zech. 14. 8
[z] Dt. 11. 24 (marg.)
[a] Is. 34. 3; Am. 4. 10
[b] Is. 54. 4; Jer. 30. 10; Zeph. 3. 16, 17
[c] ver. 26; Ps. 126. 3
[d] ch. 1. 18–20; Ps. 65. 12, 13
[e] Ps. 149. 2
[f] Is. 12. 2–6
[g] Dt. 11. 14; Jer. 5. 24
[h] Hos. 6. 3; Zech. 10. 1
[i] Lev. 26. 10; Am. 9. 13; Mal. 3. 10
[k] ver. 2–11; ch. 1. 4–7

1 Or, *war-horses*
2 Or, *when they fall around the weapons, they &c.*
3 Or, *are not wounded*
4 Or, *elders*
5 Or, *use a byword against them*
6 Or, *with its forepart*
7 Or, *toward*
8 Or, *in* (or, *for*) *righteousness*
9 Or, *at the first*

which I sent among you. 26 And ye shall [a]eat in plenty and be satisfied, and shall [b]praise the name of Jehovah your God, that hath [c]dealt wondrously with you; and my people shall never be [d]put to shame. 27 And ye shall [e]know that I am in the midst of Israel, and that I am Jehovah your God, and there is [f]none else; and my people shall never be [g]put to shame.

*28 [h]And it shall come to pass afterward, that I will pour out my [i]Spirit upon [k]all flesh; and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, your old men shall dream dreams, your young men shall see visions: 29 and also upon the [l]servants and upon the handmaids in those days will I pour out my Spirit. 30 And I will [m]show wonders in the heavens and in the earth: blood, and fire, and pillars of smoke. 31 The [n]sun shall be turned into darkness, and the moon into blood, before the [o]great and terrible day of Jehovah cometh. 32 And it shall come to pass, that [p]whosoever shall call on the name of Jehovah shall be delivered; for in mount Zion and in Jerusalem there shall be those that [q]escape, as Jehovah hath said, and [1]among the remnant those whom Jehovah doth call.

*3 For, behold, in those days, and in that time, when I shall [2r]bring back the captivity of Judah and Jerusalem, 2 I will [s]gather all nations, and will bring them down into the [t]valley of Jehoshaphat; and I will [u]execute judgment upon them there for my people and for my heritage Israel, whom they have [v]scattered among the nations: and they have [x]parted my land, 3 and have [y]cast lots for my people, and have [z]given a boy for a harlot, and sold a girl for wine, that they may drink. 4 Yea, and what are ye to me, O [a]Tyre, and Sidon, and all the regions of [b]Philistia? [3]will ye [c]render me a recompense? and if ye recompense me, swiftly and speedily will I [d]return your [4]recompense upon your own head. 5 Forasmuch as ye have [e]taken my silver and my gold, and have carried into your temples my goodly precious things, 6 and have sold the [f]children of Judah and the children of Jerusalem unto the sons of the Grecians, that ye may remove them far from their border; 7 behold, I will [g]stir them up out of the place whither ye have sold them, and will [h]return your [4]recompense upon your own head; 8 and I will sell [i]your sons and your daughters into the hand of the children of Judah, and they shall sell them to the men of [k]Sheba, to a nation far off: for Jehovah hath spoken it.

9 [l]Proclaim ye this among the nations; [5m]prepare war; [n]stir up the mighty men; let all the men of war draw near, let them come up. 10 [o]Beat your plowshares into swords, and your pruning-hooks into spears: let the weak say, I am strong. 11 [6p]Haste ye, and come, all ye nations round about, and gather yourselves together: thither cause thy [q]mighty ones to come down, O Jehovah. 12 Let the nations bestir themselves, and come up to the [r]valley of [7]Jehoshaphat; for there will I sit to [s]judge all the nations round about. 13 Put ye in the sickle; for the [8t]harvest is ripe: come, [9]tread ye; for the [u]winepress is full, the vats overflow; for their [v]wickedness is great.

14 [x]Multitudes, multitudes in the [y]valley of decision! for the [z]day of Jehovah is near in the valley of decision. 15 The [a]sun and the moon are darkened, and the stars withdraw their shining. 16 And Jehovah will [b]roar from Zion, and [c]utter his voice from Jerusalem; and the [d]heavens and the earth shall shake: but Jehovah will be [e]a refuge unto his people, and a [f]stronghold to the children of Israel. 17 So shall ye [g]know that I am Jehovah your God, dwelling in Zion my [h]holy mountain: then shall Jerusalem be [i]holy, and there shall no [k]strangers pass through her any more.

[a] Dt. 11. 15; Is. 62. 9
[b] Dt. 12. 7; Ps. 67. 5–7
[c] Ps. 126. 2, 3; Is. 25. 1
[d] Is. 45. 17
[e] ch. 3. 17, 21
[f] Is. 45. 5, 6
[g] Is. 49. 23
[h] ver. 28–32: Acts 2. 17–21
[i] Is. 32. 15; 44. 3; Ezek. 39. 29
[k] Is. 40. 5; 49. 6
*[Ch. 3. 1 in Heb.]
[l] 1 Cor. 12. 13
[m] Lk. 21. 11, 25, 26; Acts 2. 19
[n] ver. 10; ch. 3. 15; Is. 13. 9, 10; 34. 4; Mt. 24. 29; Mk. 13. 24; Acts 2. 20
[o] Zeph. 1. 14–16; Mal. 4. 1, 5
[p] Jer. 33. 3; Acts 2. 21; Rom. 10. 13
[q] Is. 4. 2; Obad. 17
[r] Jer. 16. 15
[s] Is. 66. 18; Mic. 4. 12
[t] ver. 12, 14
[u] Is. 66. 16; Jer. 25. 31
[v] Jer. 50. 17; Ezek. 34. 6
[x] Ezek. 35. 10; 36. 1–5
[y] Obad. 11; Nah. 3. 10
[z] Am. 2. 6
*[Ch. 4. 1 in Heb.]
[a] Am. 1. 9, 10; Zech. 9. 2–4
[b] Am. 1. 6–8; Zech. 9. 5–7
[c] Ezek. 25. 12–17
[d] Is. 34. 8; 59. 18
[e] 2 K. 12. 18; 2 Chr. 21. 16, 17

[f] ver. 3; Ezek. 27. 13
[g] Zech. 9. 13
[h] 1 S. 15. 33
[i] Is. 14. 2; 60. 14
[k] Job 1. 15 (marg.); Ps. 72. 10; Ezek. 38. 13
[l] Jer. 51. 27, 28
[m] Jer. 6. 4; Mic. 3. 5 (& margins)
[n] Is. 8. 9, 10; Jer. 46. 3, 4; Zech. 14. 2, 3
[o] Is. 2. 4; Mic. 4. 3
[p] Ezek. 38. 15, 16; Zeph. 3. 8
[q] Is. 13. 3
[r] ver. 2 [s] Ps. 7. 6; 98. 9; Is. 3. 13 [t] Jer. 51. 33; Hos. 6. 11 [u] Is. 63. 3; Lam. 1. 15 [v] Gen. 18. 20
[x] Is. 34. 2–8 [y] ver. 2, 12 [z] ch. 1. 15; 2. 1, 11, 31
[a] ch. 2. 10, 31 [b] Hos. 11. 10; Am. 1. 2 [c] ch. 2. 11
[d] ch. 2. 10; Ezek. 38. 19; Hag. 2. 6 [e] Ps. 61. 3; Is. 33. 16; Jer. 17. 17 [f] Jer. 16. 19; Nah. 1. 7 [g] ver. 21; ch. 2. 27 [h] Is. 11. 9; 56. 7; Ezek. 20. 40 [i] Is. 4. 3; Obad. 17 [k] Is. 52. 1; Nah. 1. 15

1 Or, *in the remnant whom &c.* 2 Or, *return to* 3 Or, *will ye repay a deed of mine, or will ye do aught unto me? swiftly &c.* 4 Or, *deed*

5 Heb. *sanctify.* 6 Or, *Assemble yourselves* 7 That is, *Jehovah judgeth.* 8 Or, *vintage* 9 Or, *get you down*

The Nations to be judged, and Judah to be delivered

18 And it shall come to pass in
that day, that the [a]mountains shall
drop down sweet wine, and the
hills shall [b]flow with milk, and all
the [c]brooks of Judah shall flow
with waters; and a [d]fountain shall
come forth from the house of Jeho-
vah, and shall water [1]the valley
of [e]Shittim. 19 Egypt shall be a
desolation, and Edom shall be a
desolate wilderness, for the [f]vio-
lence done to the children of Judah,
because they have shed innocent
blood in their land. 20 But Judah
shall [2g]abide for ever, and Jerusa-
lem from generation to generation.
21 And I will [3h]cleanse their blood,
that I have not cleansed: for Jeho-
vah [i]dwelleth in Zion.

[a] Am. 9. 13
[b] Ex. 3. 8
[c] Is. 30. 25; 35. 6
[d] Ezek. 47. 1-12
[e] Num. 25. 1; Ezek. 47. 8
[f] Obad. 10
[g] Ezek. 37. 25; Am. 9. 15
[h] Is. 4. 4; Ezek. 36. 25
[i] ver. 17

[1] That is, *the valley of acacias.*
[2] Or, *be inhabited*
[3] Or, *hold as innocent*